

Greatest Coefficient and Greatest Term

- Let $(2 + 3x)^{12} = \sum_{k=0}^{12} t_k x^k$, where $t_k = {}^{12}C_k \times 2^{12-k} \times 3^k$ is the coefficient of x^k . Write down the greatest coefficient (and leave it factored).
- Let $(7 + 3x)^{25} = \sum_{k=0}^{25} c_k x^k$. Write down the greatest coefficient (and leave it factored)
- Let $(3 + 4x)^{13} = \sum_{k=0}^{13} T_k$, where $T_k = {}^{13}C_k \times 3^{13-k} \times (4x)^k$ is the term in x^k . Write down the greatest term when $x = \frac{1}{2}$ (and leave it factored).
- Let $(1 + 5x)^{21} = \sum_{k=0}^{21} T_k$, where T_k is the term in x^k . Write down the greatest term when $x = \frac{3}{5}$ (and leave it factored).
- Let $(5 + 2x)^{15} = \sum_{k=0}^{15} t_k x^k$. Write down the greatest coefficient (and leave it factored).
 - Let $(5 + 2x)^{15} = \sum_{k=0}^{15} T_k$, where T_k is the term in x_k . Write down the greatest term when $x = \frac{5}{3}$ (and leave it factored).
- For each expansion find: (i) the greatest coefficient, (ii) the greatest term if $x = \frac{2}{3}$.
 - $(1 + 4x)^{11}$
 - $\left(2 + \frac{3}{4}x\right)^9$
 - $(5x + 3)^{12}$
 - $(5 + 6x)^{11}$
- For each of the following expansions, find: (i) the coefficient with greatest absolute value, (ii) the term with greatest absolute value if $x = \frac{2}{3}$ and $y = 3$.
 - $(1 - 7x)^9$
 - $(7 - 2x)^{14}$
 - $(x - 2y)^{12}$
 - $(2x - y)^{15}$
- For each of the following expansions, find: (i) the greatest coefficient, (ii) the greatest term if $x = \frac{3}{2}$ and $y = \frac{4}{9}$.
 - $\left(2x^2 + \frac{3}{x}\right)^{10}$
 - $(2x + 3y)^{12}$
- Show that in the expansion of $(1 + x)^{14}$, where $x = \frac{2}{3}$, two consecutive terms are equal to each other and greater than any other term.
- Let $(x + y)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n T_r$, where T_r is the term in $x^{n-r}y^r$.
 - Write down expressions for T_r and T_{r+1} and whence show that $\frac{T_{r+1}}{T_r} = \frac{(n-r)y}{(r+1)x}$.
 - Consider the expansion of $(a + 3b)^8$, where $a = 2$ and $b = \frac{3}{4}$. By substituting the appropriate values for x, y and n into the expansion in (i), show that $\frac{T_{r+1}}{T_r} = \frac{72-9r}{8r+8}$. Hence show that T_4 is the numerically greatest term in the expansion.
 - Find the greatest term in the expansion $(p + q)^{10}$, where $p = q = \frac{1}{2}$.
- Let $(1 + x)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n t_r x^r$.
 - Find the values of n and r if $t_{r+1} = 5t_r$ and $t_{r+4} = 2t_{r+3}$.
 - Hence find the greatest coefficient in the expansion.
- Let $(1 + 0.01)^{12} = \sum_{r=0}^{12} T_r$, where T_r is the term in $(0.01)^r$. Find the first value of r for which the ratio $\frac{T_{r+1}}{T_r} < 0.005$.
- Let $(\sin \theta + \cos \theta)^{20} = \sum_{k=0}^{20} T_k$, where T_k is the term in $\sin^{20-k} \theta \cos^k \theta$. Find, to the nearest degree, the first positive angle for which $T_{14} > T_{15}$.
- Show that in the expansion of $(1 + x)^n$, where n is an even integer, the term with the greatest coefficient is the term in $x^{\frac{1}{2}n}$.
 - By considering the expansion of $(1 + x)^{2n}$, for any positive integer n , prove that the largest value of ${}^{2n}C_r$ is ${}^{2n}C_n$.

Answer

1. ${}^{12}C_7 2^5 3^7$
2. ${}^{25}C_7 7^{18} 3^7$
3. ${}^{13}C_5 3^8 2^5$
4. ${}^{21}C_{16} 3^{16}$
5. a. ${}^{15}C_4 5^{11} 2^4$; b. ${}^{15}C_6 5^{15} \left(\frac{2}{3}\right)^6$
6. a. i. ${}^{11}C_9 4^9$, ii. $T_8 = {}^{11}C_8 \left(\frac{8}{3}\right)^8$; b. i. ${}^9C_2 2^3 3^2$, ii. $T_1 = T_2 = 1152$; c. i. ${}^{12}C_8 3^4 5^8$, ii. $T_6 = {}^{12}C_6 10^6$; d. i. ${}^{11}C_6 5^5 6^6$, ii. $T_5 = {}^{11}C_5 5^6 4^5$
7. a. i. ${}^9C_8 7^8$, ii. $T_8 = {}^9C_8 \left(\frac{14}{3}\right)^8$; b. i. $-{}^{14}C_3 7^{11} 2^3$, ii. $T_2 = {}^{14}C_2 7^{12} \left(\frac{4}{3}\right)^2$; c. i. ${}^{12}C_8 2^8$, ii. $T_{11} = -{}^{15}C_{11} 4^4 3^7$
8. a. i. ${}^{10}C_6 2^4 3^6$, ii. ${}^{10}C_3 9^7 2^{-4}$; b. i. ${}^{12}C_7 2^5 3^7$, ii. Two terms have the greatest value, which is 10,264,320
9. The equal terms are ${}^{14}C_6 \left(\frac{2}{3}\right)^6$ and ${}^{14}C_5 \left(\frac{2}{3}\right)^5$.
10. a. $T_{r+1} = {}^nC_{r+1} x^{n-r-1} y^{r+1}$, $T_r = {}^nC_r x^{n-r} y^r$; c. $T_5 = \frac{63}{256}$
11. a. $n = 17, r = 2$; b. ${}^{17}C_8 = {}^{17}C_9$
12. $r = 8$
13. $\theta = 22^\circ$